



NFU Mutual – Project & Portfolio Office Management

As Project & Portfolio Office Manager at NFU Mutual, I was responsible for establishing and leading a centralised PMO function to enhance delivery governance, portfolio visibility, and resource optimisation across multiple business and technology programmes.

Operating within a regulated financial-services environment, the role demanded strategic oversight, disciplined planning, and stakeholder alignment across diverse delivery teams.

Service Establishment & Governance Framework

My initial focus was to assess the existing project-delivery landscape and design a fit-for-purpose PMO framework that supported NFU Mutual's transformation objectives.

Key activities:

- Conducted full PMO service review and maturity assessment
- Defined governance standards, reporting cadence, and assurance processes

- Implemented portfolio-level dashboards for visibility of progress, risk, and spend
- Introduced standardised templates for project initiation, planning, and closure
- Embedded quality-assurance checkpoints across the delivery lifecycle

The outcome was a structured, transparent governance model that improved decision-making and delivery predictability.

Portfolio Management & Delivery Oversight

I led the portfolio management function, ensuring alignment between strategic priorities and operational execution across technology, business change, and compliance initiatives.

Responsibilities:

- Portfolio planning, prioritisation, and resource allocation
- Tracking delivery performance against KPIs and milestones
- Managing dependencies and cross-programme risks
- Facilitating executive portfolio reviews and investment decisions
- Coordinating with business units and IT delivery teams

This approach provided NFU Mutual with a consolidated view of delivery health and investment performance.

Financial & Resource Management

I managed the financial governance and resource planning for the portfolio, ensuring cost efficiency and accountability across all workstreams.

Key achievements:

- Established cost-tracking and forecasting mechanisms
- Managed PMO budget and vendor contracts
- Introduced resource-capacity planning tools
- Supported commercial negotiations and service-level adherence

This financial discipline reinforced transparency and value realisation across the portfolio.

Leadership & Stakeholder Engagement

As PMO lead, I built and managed a high-performing team, fostering collaboration and continuous improvement.

Focus areas:

- Team leadership and mentoring
- Capability development and performance management
- Stakeholder engagement across business and IT leadership
- Embedding a culture of delivery excellence and accountability

The PMO became a trusted partner to senior stakeholders, providing clarity, control, and confidence in delivery outcomes.

Strategic Impact

The engagement delivered a mature, commercially aware PMO service that strengthened NFU Mutual's ability to manage complex portfolios and deliver strategic change effectively.

It enhanced governance, improved delivery assurance, and established a sustainable framework for future transformation initiatives.